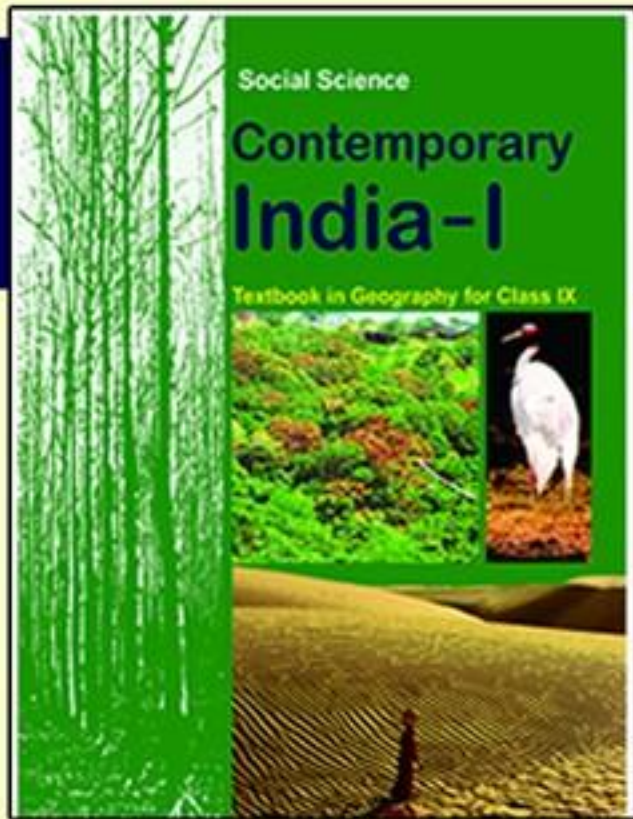




Learning **Space**



NCERT BASICS



GEOGRAPHY

**NATURAL VEGETATION
AND WILDLIFE**

MODULE - 7



NATURAL VEGETATION

VEGETATION REGION

1. Forest

A large area of land that's covered in trees.

2. Grassland

Eco-system with large, flat areas of grasses.

3. Tundra

Flat, treeless region separated by the tree line from a forest.

4. Desert

Areas with an average annual precipitation of less than 10 inches per year.

5. Ice-Sheet

Thick layer of glacial ice that covers a large area of land.

1. FORESTS**BRIEF INTRODUCTION**

Forests are areas with trees grouped in a way so their leaves, or foliage, shade the ground.

- Types of forests can generally be classified on the basis of :
 - The type of trees a forest has.
 - The type of leaves on their trees.

1. FORESTS

NATURAL VEGETATION

TYPES OF FORESTS



I. DECIDUOUS FORESTS



II. TROPICAL EVERGREEN FORESTS



III. CONIFEROUS FORESTS



IV. MANGROVE FORESTS

I. DECIDUOUS FORESTS



- ✓ Trees in these forests have green leaves that change color in the fall and drop altogether in the winter.
- ✓ Trees that are common in deciduous forests are Oak and Maple.

1. FORESTS

NATURAL VEGETATION

I. DECIDUOUS FORESTS

MOIST DECIDUOUS FORESTS

- These are the regions, where the rainfall is between 70 cm and 200 cm.
- Trees shed their leaves for about six to eight weeks in dry summer.

FOUND IN: Lower slope of the Himalayas, West Bengal, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Orissa, Karnataka, Maharashtra Jharkhand, and the adjoining areas.

SPECIES: Teak, Sal, Shisham, Hurra, Mahua, Amla, Semul, Kusum, Sandalwood.

DRY DECIDUOUS FORESTS

- These are the regions, where the rainfall is between 70 - 100 cm.
- These forests experience the prolonged seasonal drought.

FOUND IN: Areas of the Central Deccan plateau, Punjab, Haryana, parts of Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, and South-east of Rajasthan.

SPECIES: Tendu, Palas, Amaltas, Bel, Khair, Axlewood.

1. FORESTS

II. TROPICAL EVERGREEN FORESTS

- Tropical evergreen forests are dense, multi-layered.
- These areas receive more than 200 cm of rainfall throughout the year.
- The temperature remains very high.
- The trees are very tall.



DID YOU KNOW!

The greatest single area of tropical evergreen forest is found in the Amazon Basin, in the northern half of South America.

II. TROPICAL EVERGREEN FORESTS



- ✓ They are largely found in the Northeastern regions of Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Assam, Nagaland, the Western Ghats, the Tarai areas of the Himalayas, and the Andaman groups of Islands.
- ✓ They are also found in the hills of Khasi and Jaintia.

1. FORESTS



III. CONIFEROUS FORESTS

- ✓ Coniferous forests consist mostly of **conifers**, which are trees that grow needles.
- ✓ These are also called Taiga.
- ✓ Seen in higher latitudes (in between 50° - 70°).
- ✓ Coniferous forests have the tallest (coast redwood), largest (giant sequoia), and oldest (bristlecone pine) trees in the World.

1. FORESTS

CONIFEROUS FORESTS IN INDIA

The **Eastern Himalayan subalpine conifer forests** is found in northern Indian states including Arunachal Pradesh and Sikkim.



IV. MANGROVE FORESTS

- Mangroves are a special type of vegetation.
- They are the salt-tolerant variety of plants, which can survive in harsh conditions.
- The tidal or mangrove forests grow by the side of the coast and on the edges of the deltas e.g., the deltas of the Cauvery, Krishna, Mahanadi, Godavari, and Ganga.
- In West Bengal, these forests are known as 'Sundarbans'. The 'Sundari' is the most common tree in these forests.



2. GRASSLANDS

- They are flat and open areas where grasses are the dominant type of vegetation.
- Grasslands can be found on every continent except Antarctica.
- Climate plays a role in the type of grassland you get.



2. GRASSLANDS

TEMPERATE GRASSLANDS

- These exist where there are seasonal variations in temperature over the course of the year: hot summers and cold winters.
- Different grasses thrive in different temperatures here.



TROPICAL GRASSLANDS

- These are called savannas.
- They do well in weather that is warm year-round and usually pretty dry.
- The most famous savannas are in Africa



2. GRASSLANDS

- Grasslands occupy nearly 24 percent of the geographical area in India.
- The major types of grasslands in India are:
 - The alpine moist meadows of the Greater Himalayas;
 - Alpine arid pastures or steppe formations of the trans Himalayas;
 - Hillside grasslands in the mid-elevation ranges of the Himalayas;
 - 'Chauris' of the Himalayan foothills;
 - 'Terai' grasslands on the Gangetic and the Brahmaputra floodplains;
 - 'Phumdis' or floating grasslands of Manipur;
 - 'Banni' and 'Vidis' of Gujarat;
 - Savannas of western and peninsular India;
 - Plateau and valley grasslands in the Satpuras and Maikal hills;
 - Dry grasslands of the Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu plains;
 - 'Shola' grasslands of the Western Ghats.



3. TUNDRA

- Tundra is an area where tree growth is difficult because of cold temperatures and short seasons.
- Vegetation in tundra is limited to a few shrubs, grasses, and mosses.



3. TUNDRA

ALPINE TUNDRA

- It is separated from a forest vegetation region by the tree line.
- The area beyond which conditions are too harsh or cold for tree growth.



ARCTIC TUNDRA

- It occurs in the far northern hemisphere of the Earth.
- It has a bare landscape and is frozen for much of the year.





MONTANE FORESTS IN INDIA

WET TEMPERATE FOREST

- The mean annual rainfall here is 150 cm to 300 cm.
- **Found In:** Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Eastern Himalayas to the east of 88°E longitude including the hills of Assam, West Bengal, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh and Nagaland.
- **Important Species:** Chilauni, Indian chestnut, Deodar, Machilus, Cinnamomum, Litsea, Plum, Blue pine, Birch, Oak, Hemlock, etc.

TEMPERATE FOREST

- The annual rainfall varies from 150 cm to 250 cm.
- **Found In:** The overall length of mountain ranges in Kashmir, Uttaranchal, Himachal Pradesh, Sikkim and Darjeeling are covered by Himalayan temperate forests.
- **Important Species:** Pine, Deodar, Silver Fir, Spruce, Cedar trees and some kinds of Bamboos.

ALPINE FOREST

- The rainfall is below 100 cm here.
- **Found In:** Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Tripura, Western Ghats, Satpura, Maikal, Chota Nagpur plateau, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Orissa and adjoining areas of Andhra Pradesh and Chhattisgarh.
- **Important Species:** Lichens and mosses.



4. DESERTS

- Deserts have almost no precipitation, or rainfall.
- Deserts usually have really high daytime temperatures, low night time temperatures, and very low humidity.
- Plant life is highly specialized to adapt to these coarse, dry conditions, with long roots, small leaves, stems that store water, and prickly spines that discourage animals from touching or eating them.
- Desert soil is often sandy, rocky, or gravelly.



These vegetation are found in parts of Gujarat's, Punjab, and Rajasthan.



- The largest desert in the world is the Antarctic Desert, which takes up most of the continent of Antarctica.
- In the Antarctic Desert, ice sheets cover barren rock.



5. ICE SHEET

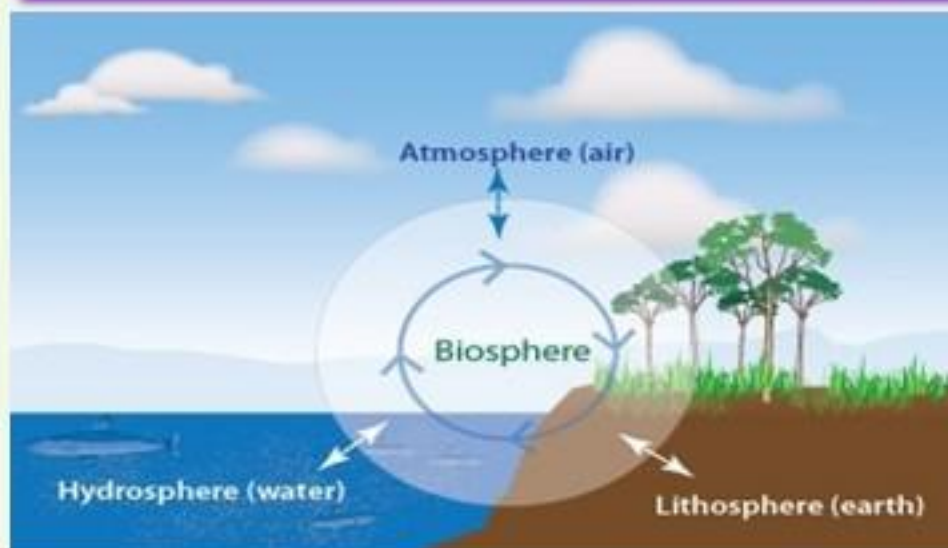
- The interesting thing about the ice sheet “vegetation region” is that there really isn’t any vegetation there at all!
- An ice sheet is a large stretch of glacier ice that covers the land all around it for more than 50,000 square kilometers
- Currently, the only ice sheets are in Antarctica and Greenland.





BIOSPHERE

- It is that part of the Earth inhabited by living organisms, including land, ocean and the atmosphere in which life can exist.
- It is referred to the combination of all ecosystems on Earth.
- This includes all living components, non-living components, and their relationships.



ECOSYSTEM

- A geographic area where plants, animals, and other organisms, as well as weather and landscape, work together to form a bubble of life.
- It can be defined as a part/area of the biosphere.
- It includes the living and non-living components of the Earth.





NATIONAL PARK

- It is a relatively large area of scenic beauty protected and maintained by the Government to preserve flora and fauna, landscape, historic objects of the area and places of scientific interest.
- It is highly restricted and people cannot randomly access it.
- National parks are majorly famous for protecting the fauna, flora, landscape and historical entities.



WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

- Area with an environment that protects animal habitat and its surroundings from the interference of any sort.
- It is natural habitat that is run by the governing bodies or private organizations that protects certain species of animals and birds.
- Wildlife sanctuaries are known for wildlife conservation, which consists of insects, animals, birds, and microorganisms of various species and genes.





BIOSPHERE RESERVE

- ✓ Biosphere reserves are 'learning places for sustainable development'.
- ✓ Biosphere Reserve (BR) is an international designation by United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) for representative parts of natural and cultural landscapes extending over large areas of terrestrial or coastal/marine ecosystems.

TIGER RESERVE

It consists of a 'Core' or 'Critical Tiger Habitat', which is to be managed as an inviolate area, and a 'Buffer' or Peripheral area immediately abutting a Core area, which may be accorded a lesser degree of habitat protection.
This is the typical zonation of a Tiger Reserve.

ELEPHANT RESERVE

The reserve is aiming at reducing human-animal conflict and destruction of property in addition to providing a permanent habitat to the elephants.



BIOSPHERE RESERVES OF INDIA





The International Union for Conservation of Nature is an international organization working in the field of nature conservation and sustainable use of natural resources.

- ✓ **Headquarters:** Gland, Switzerland.
- ✓ **Founder:** Julian Huxley.
- ✓ **Founded:** 5 October 1948, Fontainebleau, France.
- ✓ **Motto:** United for Life and Livelihoods.



THE INTERNATIONAL UNION FOR CONSERVATION OF NATURE RED LIST

- Following are the 9 categories in the IUCN red list:
- Extinct (EX) – No known individuals remaining.
 - Extinct in the wild (EW) – Known only to survive in captivity, or as a naturalized population outside its historic range.
 - Critically endangered (CR) – Extremely high risk of extinction in the wild.
 - Endangered (EN) – High risk of extinction in the wild.
 - Vulnerable (VU) – High risk of endangerment in the wild.
 - Near threatened (NT) – Likely to become endangered soon.
 - Least concern (LC) – Lowest risk. Does not qualify for a more at-risk category. Widespread and abundant taxa are included in this category.
 - Data deficient (DD) – Not enough data to assess its risk of extinction.
 - Not evaluated (NE) – Has not yet been evaluated against the criteria



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